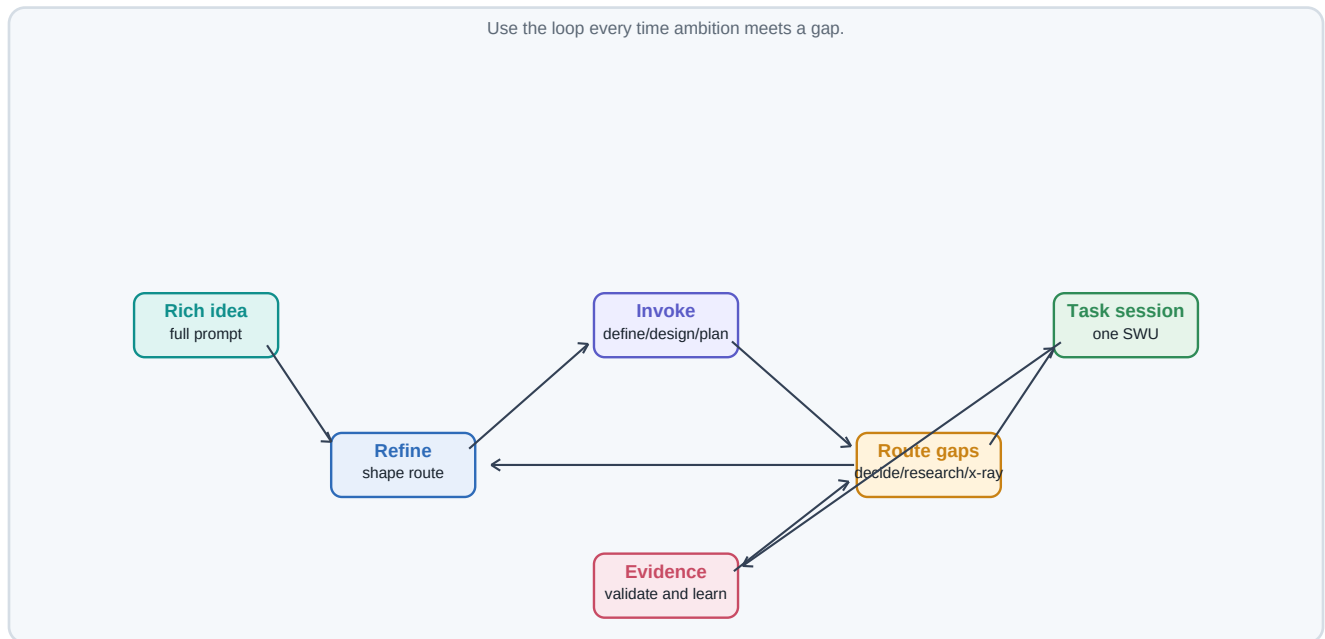


Arcanum Development Usage Guide

A printable map for turning an ambitious idea into definition, design, plan, bounded execution, and evidence.

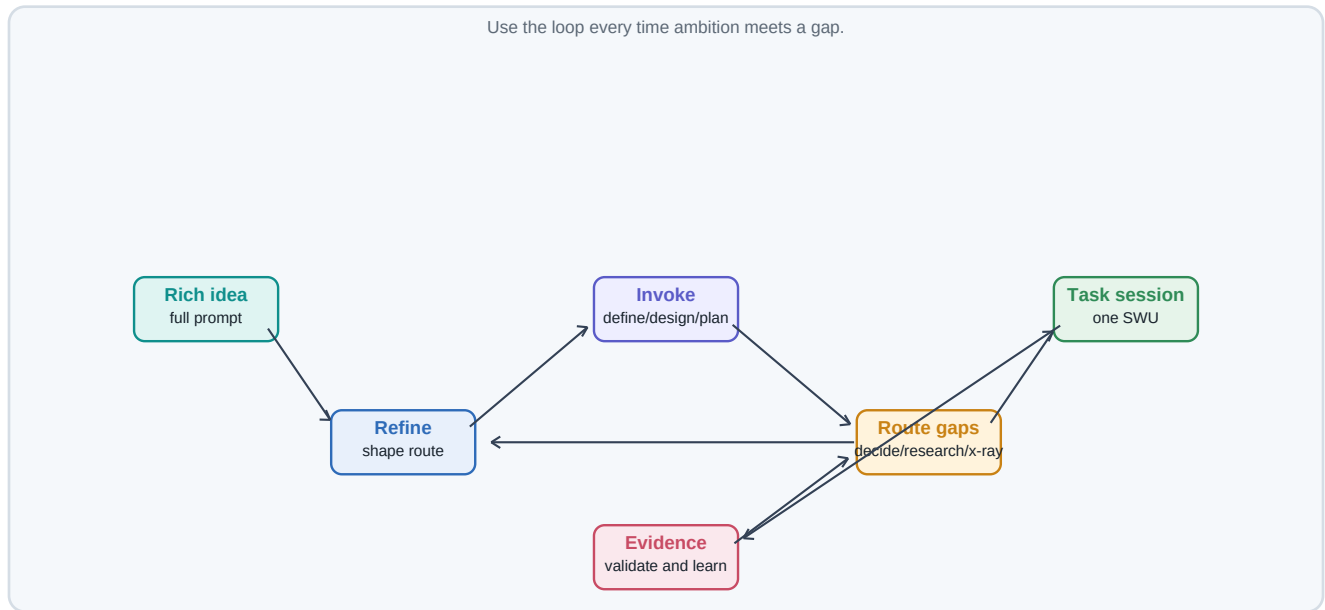


Core promise: do not rush from idea to implementation. Make the idea inspectable, argued, evidenced, planned, and then executed in small verified steps.

Start with	End with	Repeat when
The richest prompt you can write: user, pain, promise, examples, constraints, risks, and unknowns.	One verified task or SWU, with receipts and a next route for remaining residue.	A blocker, research gap, design doubt, validation miss, or new ambition appears.

1. The Whole Loop

Arcanum development is a loop with explicit ownership. Refine shapes the idea, invoke authors durable artifacts, blocker tools route uncertainty, and task-session executes one ready unit.

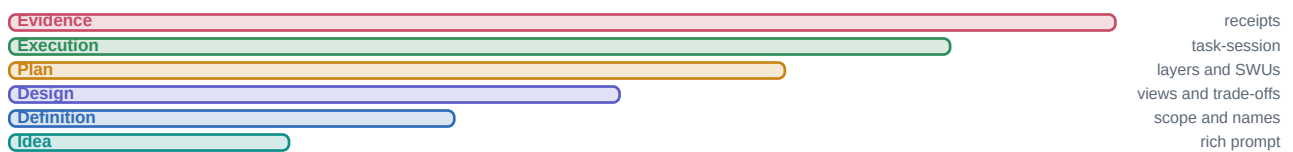


The short version

```
rich idea prompt -> refine -> invoke define/design/plan -> gaps and blockers -> decision-gate | dispatch-spec |  
x-ray | refine -> task-session -> validation evidence -> repeat
```

What changes as you move right

Evidence should get heavier as mutation gets real.



2. First Prompt Anatomy

The first prompt should be rich, not polished. It gives refine enough material to preserve ambition while finding the next executable route.

User and Promise

Who it is for, what they should become able to do, and why it matters.

Current Reality

Existing tools, workflows, artifacts, constraints, and visible friction.

Ambition

What makes the idea exciting and what the larger version could become.

Boundaries

What should not happen, what should not be inferred, and decisions humans must make.

Evidence

References, examples, screenshots, prior artifacts, and market or research leads.

MVP Proof

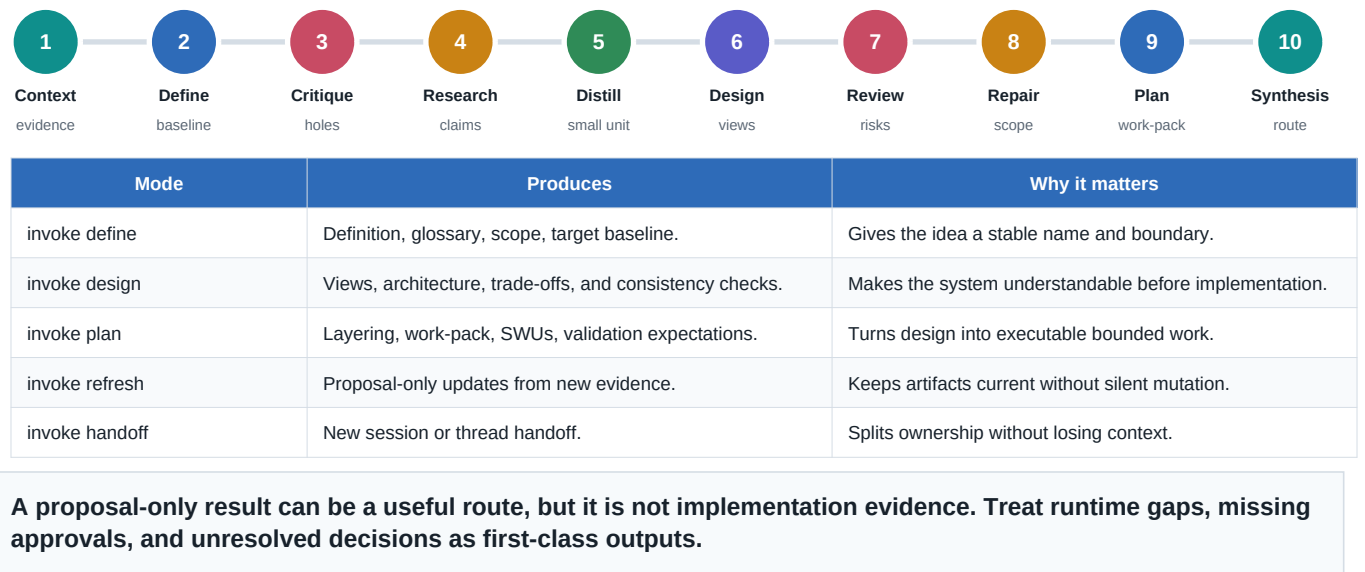
What one small successful version would need to prove with evidence.

Reusable prompt card

```
[${refine}] I want to develop this idea:  
<Describe the idea in as much detail as possible: users, promise, current workflow, missing pieces, constraints, examples, risks, unresolved decisions, MVP proof, and ambitious future.>  
  
Please refine this into a development route. I want definition, design, plan, gaps, blockers, and the next executable task.
```

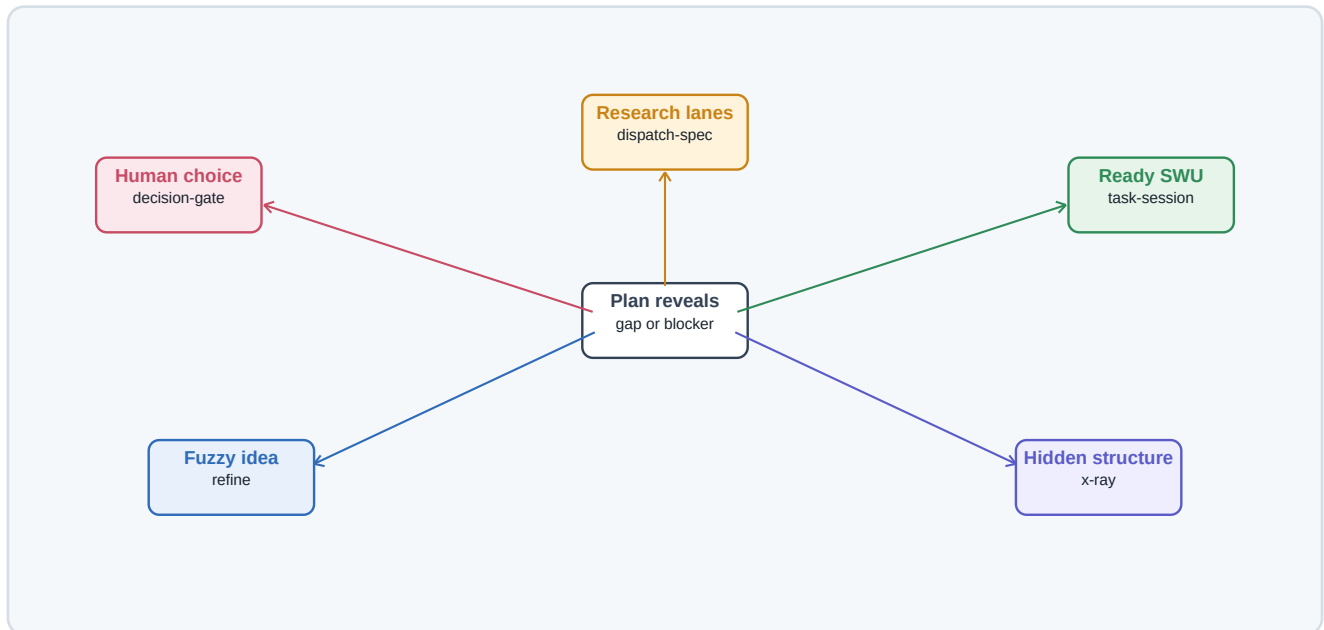
3. Refine To Invoke To Plan

Refine is the front door for broad or under-shaped work. Invoke turns the refined direction into durable artifacts that later sessions can execute and inspect.



4. Gap And Blocker Router

A good plan reveals gaps. Do not smooth them over. Route each gap to the capability that can resolve it with the right kind of evidence.



Situation	Use	Reason
Consequential choice with multiple viable options.	decision-gate	Records options, trade-offs, decision, and blocked state.
Idea, design, or plan still feels broad.	refine	Runs another refinement pass around the gap.
Multiple research streams or reusable route.	dispatch-spec	Creates lanes, gates, handoffs, and observability.
Architecture or workflow is hard to see.	x-ray	Explains parts, dependencies, flow, lifecycle, and risks.
One bounded task is ready.	task-session	Executes one unit with validation and synchronized evidence.

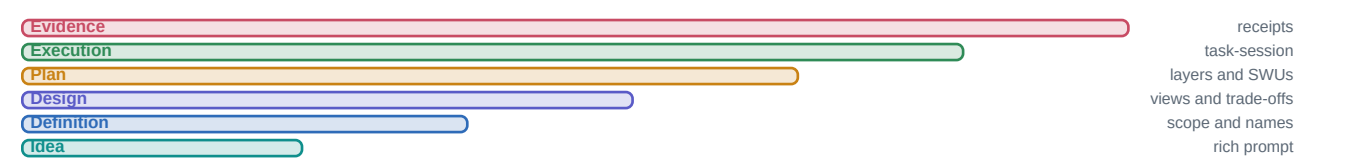
5. Task Session And Evidence

Task-session is the execution route only after the unit is bounded enough to work safely. It should mutate declared scope, validate done criteria, and report follow-up residue.

Ready means	Task-session should
• The task or SWU is bounded. • Inputs and source links are known. • Write scope is clear. • Blockers are resolved or recorded. • Validation surface exists. • Completion evidence is defined.	• Build a context pack. • Evaluate gates. • Call decision-gate if a blocker-level choice appears. • Mutate only declared scope. • Validate done criteria. • Synchronize task evidence.

Evidence receipt model

Evidence should get heavier as mutation gets real.



A finished interface, sigil, spell, or workflow should leave enough evidence for another person to see what changed, why it changed, and what remains uncertain.

6. Designer Ambition Surface

Designers can use Arcanum as a creative amplifier, not just a ticket machine. The system can turn taste, intent, research, structure, and validation evidence into tools that teams can reuse.



Capability	How a designer can use it
whisper	Shape the voice, constraints, review prompts, and writing residues of a tool or interface.
guide	Create a teachable route so others can use the capability without knowing its internals.
x-ray	Make hidden flows, dependencies, assumptions, and lifecycle states understandable.
ux evidence validator	Turn finished frontend review into screenshots, measurements, accessibility signals, and human review prompts.
dispatch-spec	Research academic, market, technical, and risk references in separate lanes.
task-session	Build one concrete piece at a time while preserving proof and residue.

7. Printable Prompt Cards

Decision Gate	
	<code>[\$decision-gate]</code> Resolve the blocker for <code><target></code>. Context: current plan, consequential choice, visible options, affected artifacts, and what must not proceed until this is decided.
Dispatch Spec	
	<code>[\$dispatch-spec]</code> Create a research route for <code><topic></code>. Streams: source truth, market practice, implementation, risks, validation or fixtures. Output: source ledger, claim map, implications, blockers.
X-Ray	
	<code>[\$x-ray]</code> Explain <code><target></code> for <code><audience></code>. Focus: what it is, parts, responsibilities, flows, dependencies, lifecycle, assumptions, risks, open questions, next route.
Task Session	
	<code>[\$task-session]</code> Execute <code><work-pack path> --task <TASK-ID></code> Use only when the unit is bounded, scope is known, blockers are handled, and evidence expectations are clear.

8. What Good Looks Like

Good Arcanum development leaves a trail: definition, design, plan, decisions, research, x-rays, task receipts, residues, and the next bounded step.

Clear Definition

A stable name, purpose, boundary, and vocabulary.

Visible Design

Multiple views, trade-offs, dependencies, and risks.

Executable Plan

Layers, SWUs, validators, and completion criteria.

Recorded Decisions

Consequential choices are explicit and durable.

Sourced Research

Claims stay linked to evidence and freshness rules.

Validation Receipts

Finished work has proof, limits, and remaining residue.

Avoid

- Jumping straight from idea to implementation.
- Running task-session before the task is bounded.
- Hiding human decisions inside implementation.
- Treating proposal-only refreshes as permission to mutate.
- Using research findings as canonical truth without review.
- Claiming MVP completion without validation evidence.

Source guide: development/user-guide/ARCANUM-DEVELOPMENT-USAGE-GUIDE.md

Generated artifact: development/user-guide/ARCANUM-DEVELOPMENT-USAGE-GUIDE.print.pdf